

# Les Veilleurs — Crystal showcase (“aquarium”)

Tender documentation v02.2 · September 2026 · stainless-steel fabrication / metal joinery — request for constructive advice and price estimate

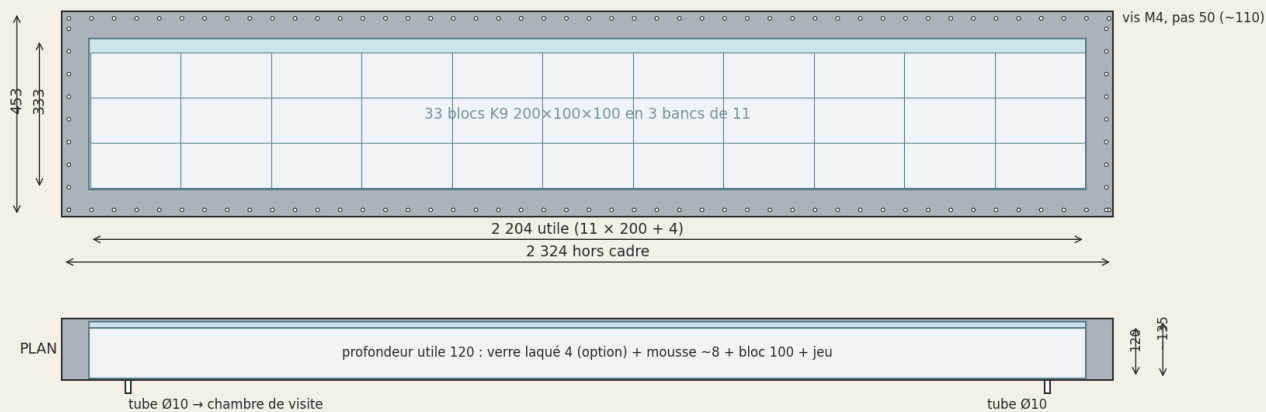
## 1. What this is

A permanent artwork on the Belgian coast (Beaufort 27, North Sea). Set into its stone base, a niche displays 33 laser-engraved optical crystal blocks on a black background behind a glass pane, in a dry-nitrogen atmosphere that protects them from sea humidity. We are looking for a workshop to build this niche: a welded, airtight stainless-steel box and its removable glazed cover. It is a one-off, hand-built piece meant to last decades outdoors and to be opened and serviced on site. The dimensions below are our proposal; your view on what would be simpler, safer or cheaper to make interests us as much as your price.

## 2. Main dimensions

| Item                                           | Dimension / value                               | Note                                                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Usable inner cavity L × H × D                  | 2,204 × 333 × 120 mm                            | 11 blocks of 200 per row + 4 mm shims; 3 rows of 100 + 3 mm top clearance + 30 mm reserve |
| Box overall (sheet)                            | 2,324 × 453 × ~135 mm                           | = 60 mm flat frame around the cavity                                                      |
| Visible frame on the front                     | 60 mm                                           | the artist wants it as discreet as possible: 50 mm welcome if the rebate allows           |
| Laminated low-iron glass 66.2, anti-reflective | ≈ 2,264 × 393 × 13 mm — ≈ 29 kg                 | 2 × 6 mm low-iron + PVB; anti-reflective coating on the outer face; polished edges        |
| K9 crystal blocks                              | 33 × (200 × 100 × 100) — ≈ 166 kg               | supplied and installed by us, on site                                                     |
| Loaded mass                                    | ≈ 350 kg                                        | box ≈ 60, frame ≈ 26, clamping bars ≈ 63, glass ≈ 29, blocks ≈ 166                        |
| Clamping screws                                | ≈ 110 × M4×30 countersunk Torx, 50 mm pitch     | no screw passes through the glass                                                         |
| Sealing                                        | EPDM cord Ø10 compressed ~30 % in a 2 mm groove | the bar's shoulder sets the compression, not the screw torque                             |

03 — Vue de face et plan cotés, 3 × 11 blocs (mm)



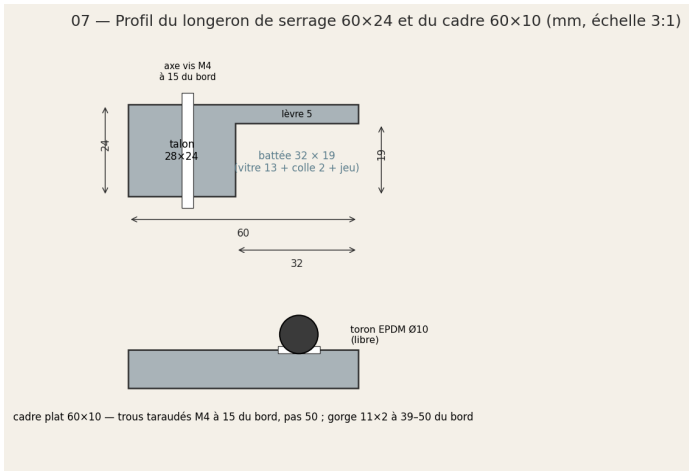
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| <b>PROJECT</b><br><b>LES VEILLEURS — Beaufort 27</b><br><b>ARTIST · PROJECT LEAD</b><br>Eva L'Hoest · +32 495 57 92 12 · eva.lhoest@gmail.com<br><b>ELECTROMECHANICAL ASSISTANT</b><br>Gioacchino Miceli · +32 497 84 45 10<br>gioacchino.miceli@thefactory.com | <b>DOCUMENT</b><br><b>Crystal showcase — tender</b><br><b>SUBJECT</b><br>Stainless box, glazed cover, seal<br><b>DOCUMENT No.</b> <b>REVISION</b> <b>DATE · TIME</b><br><b>LV-AQ-CONS-02</b> v02.2    25-09-2026 · 02:46 | <b>STATUS</b><br><b>FOR TENDER</b><br><b>PAGE</b><br>1 / 8<br><small>© Eva L'Hoest 2026 — Confidential. No reproduction, distribution or use outside this tender without the artist's written consent. Dimensions not contractual.</small> |
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### 3. Part-by-part description

**3.1 Box (316L stainless, 3 mm sheet)** — Sheet bent into a U (back + top and bottom walls), inner radius  $\leq 3$  mm. Two 3 mm end plates welded with a continuous seam, inner seams ground flush: the cavity must stay smooth, the blocks slide against the walls. Stiffeners on the outside only: 3 horizontal and 4 vertical 40×40×4 angles, stitch-welded (30/150). The back must not deflect more than 1 mm under 170 kg of distributed blocks. Two  $\varnothing 10 \times 1$  tube stubs welded into the upper back wall at both ends, 200 mm straight, plain ends (compression fitting). Two removable M8 lifting lugs on top.

**3.2 Front frame (60×10 stainless flat bar)** — Welded all around the opening, mitred or lapped corners, then the front face dressed after welding: flatness  $\leq 0.3$  mm/m (this is the seal's bearing face). M4 tapped holes, axis 15 mm from the outer edge, 50 mm pitch, two holes 25 mm from each corner. Cord locating groove: 11 wide, 2 deep, axis 44.5 mm from the outer edge, continuous, R10 rounded corners.

**3.3 Cover: four machined clamping bars (316L stainless, 60×24)** — Profile: solid 28×24 shoulder bearing on the frame, 32×19 rebate on the inner side receiving the glass (13 mm + 2 mm adhesive + clearance), 5 mm lip on the front. Countersunk M4 holes matching the tapped holes. Corner joint to be proposed by the workshop (dowelled-and-bonded mitre, or corners machined from solid). Visible finish: brushed or polished, sample to be agreed.



**3.4 Glass and bonding** — Laminated low-iron glass 66.2: two 6 mm low-iron panes (e.g. AGC Clearvision, Saint-Gobain Diamant, Pilkington Optiwhite) laminated with two clear PVB layers, i.e. 13 mm. **Anti-reflective coating** on the outer face (face 1) — durable magnetron coating such as AGC Clearsight, Pilkington OptiView or Glas Trösch Luxar Classic — so the engravings stay legible under the North Sea sky; no coating on the inner face, where the blocks bear directly. Polished edges. Bonded into the rebate with structural silicone (Dow 993 / Sika SG-20 type, 30 mm band, 2 mm base and flank), no glass-to-metal contact: the cover becomes one rigid, handleable piece. This step may go to your usual glazier or to ours: please say which in your reply.

**3.5 Seal and screws** — Solid EPDM cord  $\varnothing 10$  vulcanised into a continuous frame to the groove dimensions (+ 1 spare). M4×30 countersunk Torx T20 A4 stainless screws, tightened crosswise, about 2 N·m; the bar's shoulder bottoms on the frame 5 mm above the groove floor, so seal compression is the same everywhere whatever the enthusiasm of the person tightening.

**3.6 Option: LED strip at the top of the box** — A sealed LED profile (IP67, 24 V, ~3 W, 3000 K, length  $\approx 2,100$  mm) fixed under the top wall, inside the cavity, for downward grazing light on the blocks. We supply the profile; we ask you to price its fixing (two rails or lugs welded under the top wall, 3 mm reserve) and a third sealed  $\varnothing 6$  stub in the upper back wall for the cable, with stainless cable gland.

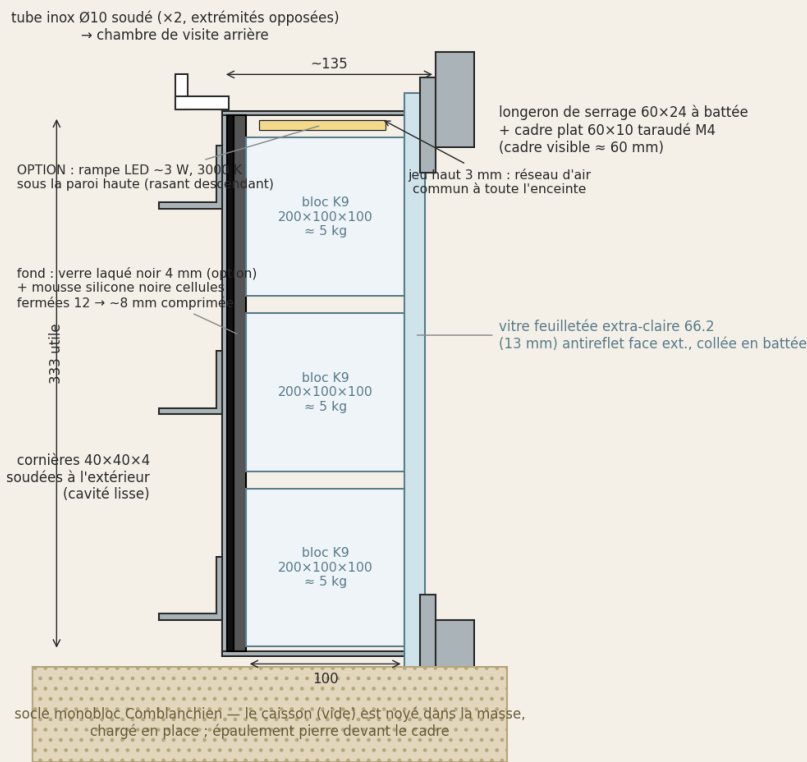
**3.7 Not in your scope** — Black background (4 mm lacquered glass or black foam), 12 mm closed-cell silicone foam at the back, end shims, blocks, the LED profile itself, valves, desiccant and pressure-balancing bladder in the service chamber, grouting into the base: supplied and installed by us.

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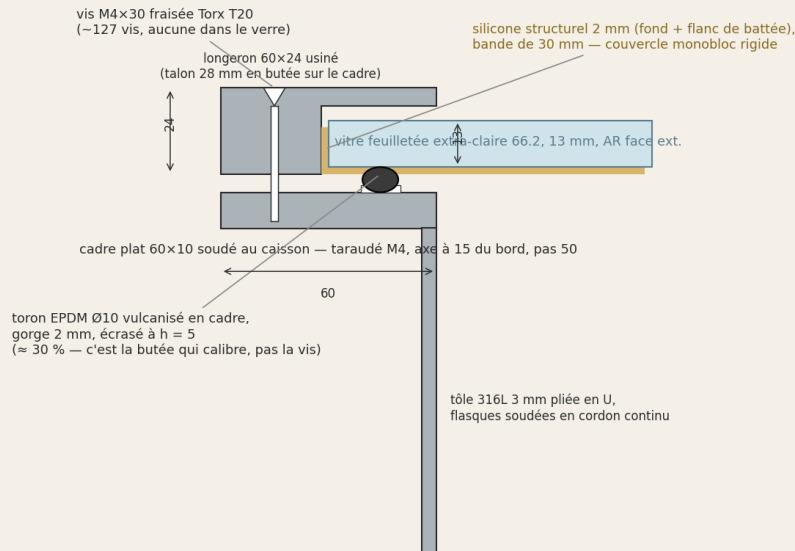
4. Drawings

Drawings are labelled in French; dimensions are in millimetres.

01 — Coupe verticale de principe (cotes en mm, échelle indicative)

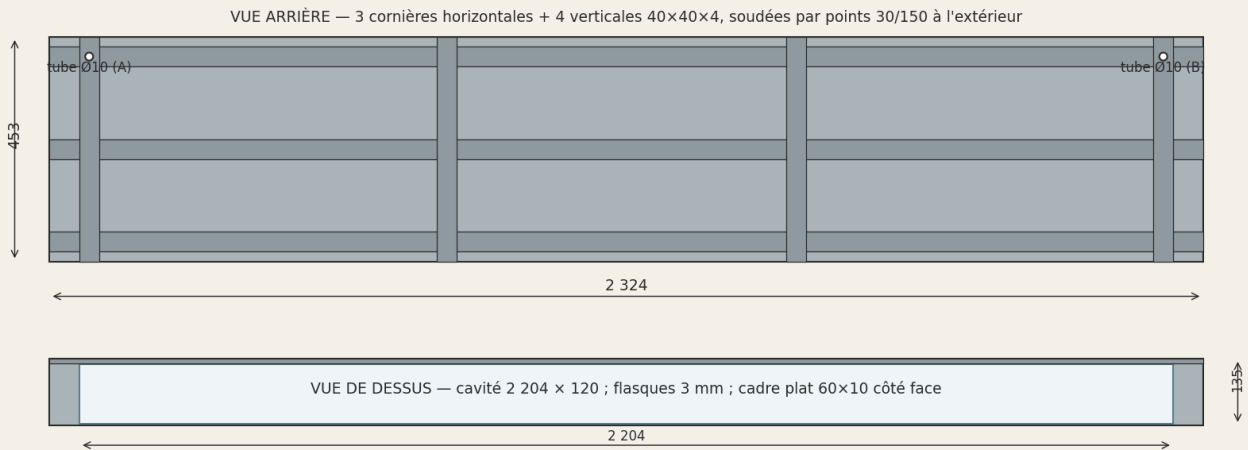


02 — Détail du serrage périphérique : longeron à battée (cotes en mm)

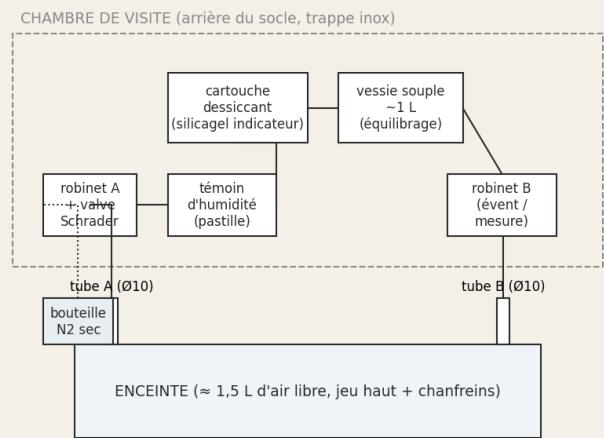


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06 — Caisson soudé : vue arrière (cornières extérieures) et vue de dessus (mm)



04 — Circuit de conditionnement d'air : azote sec, équilibrage, dessiccant, essais

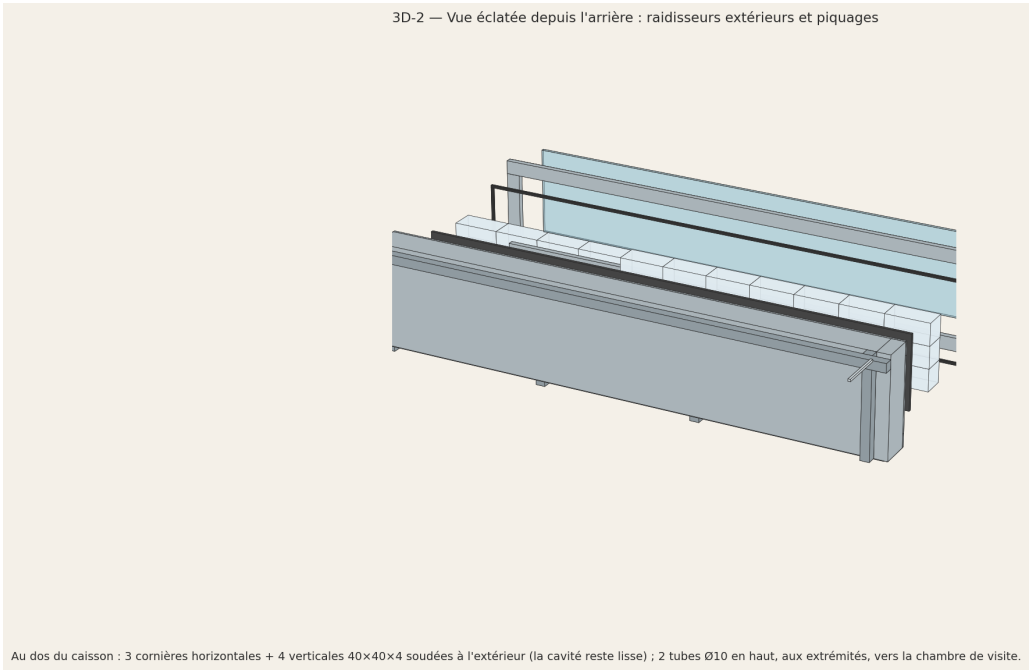
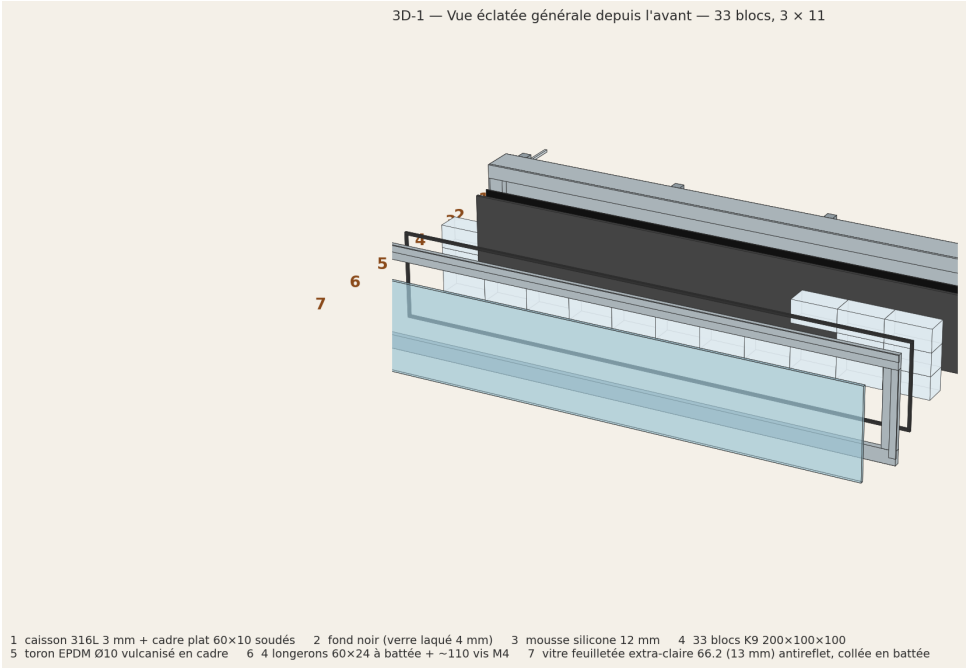


Fermeture : balayage azote sec A → B (10 volumes), fermer B puis A ; la vessie absorbe la respiration thermique (~10 %) ;  
recette : tirer -0,2 bar par la valve, fermer, lire la remontée — critère perte < 50 mbar / 24 h. Re-balayage sans démontage.

The gas circuit is shown to explain what the two tubes are for; it is not in your scope.

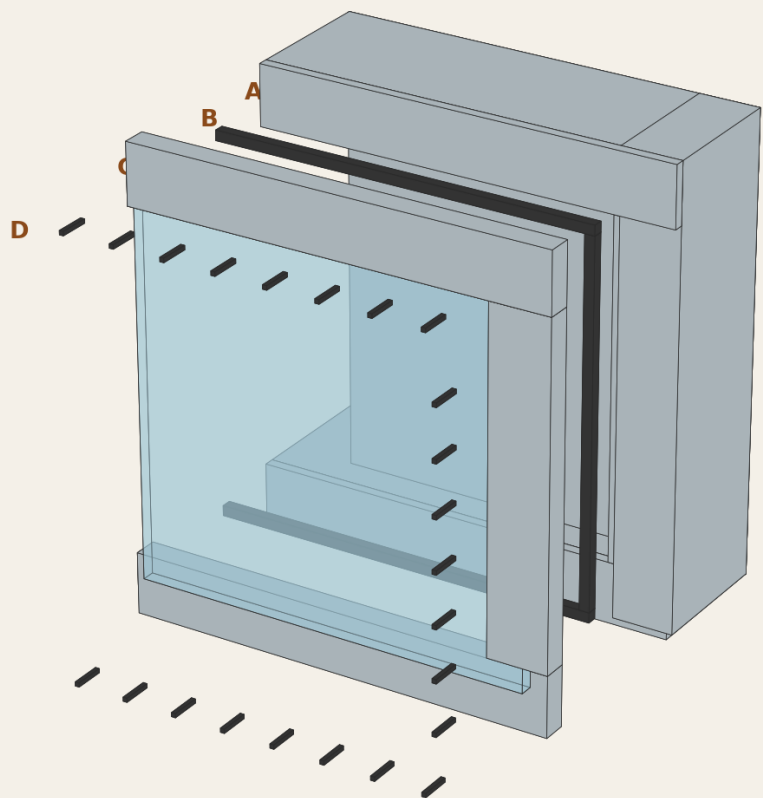
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4 bis. Exploded 3D views



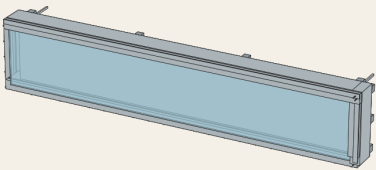
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3D-4 — Détail d'angle éclaté : cadre, toron, longeron à battée, vitre, vis



A cadre plat 60×10 soudé au caisson, taraudé M4 (pas 50, axe à 15 du bord), gorge 11×2  
B toron EPDM Ø10 vulcanisé en cadre C longeron 60×24 à battée 32×19, vitre 13 mm collée au silicone structurel D vis M4×30 fraisées Torx T20

3D-3 — Ensemble assemblé (caisson vide, couvercle vissé)



Cadre visible 60 mm, vis fraisées Torx en façade (pas 50) — aucune vis ne traverse le verre ; le couvercle se démonte d'une pièce.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                               |               |
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## 5. Indicative bill of materials

| Ref. | Description                                   | Material                 | Qty             | Dimensions / note                                   |
|------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | U-bent sheet (back + top + bottom)            | 316L 3 mm                | 1               | blank $\approx 2,324 \times (135+453+135)$          |
| 2    | End plates                                    | 316L 3 mm                | 2               | $453 \times 135$ , continuous seam                  |
| 3    | External stiffening angles                    | 316L 40×40×4             | 7               | $3 \times 2,324 + 4 \times 453$                     |
| 4    | Front flat frame                              | 316L 60×10               | $\approx 5.6$ m | M4 tapped 50 pitch, 11×2 groove, face dressed       |
| 5    | Rebated clamping bars                         | 316L 60×24 machined      | 4               | $2 \times 2,324 + 2 \times 453$ (corners to define) |
| 6    | Laminated low-iron AR glass                   | 66.2 low-iron, AR face 1 | 1               | $\approx 2,264 \times 393$ , polished edges         |
| 7    | Structural silicone                           | Dow 993 / SG-20          | $\approx 0.4$ L | 30 mm band, 2 mm                                    |
| 8    | EPDM cord Ø10 vulcanised frame                | EPDM 70 Sh               | 1 + 1           | perimeter $\approx 5.5$ m                           |
| 9    | M4×30 countersunk Torx T20 screws             | A4 stainless             | $\approx 115$   | crosswise tightening                                |
| 10   | Ø10×1 tube stubs                              | 316L                     | 2               | 200 mm, plain ends                                  |
| 11   | Removable lifting lugs                        | stainless M8             | 2               | on top                                              |
| 12   | LED option: Ø6 stub + gland + profile fixings | 316L                     | 1               | LED profile supplied by us                          |

## 6. What we ask of you

| Package             | Content                                                                                                  | To price                                        |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| A — Box             | refs 1 to 4, 10, 11: bending, airtight welding, stiffeners, dressed frame, tapping, groove               | firm price + lead time                          |
| B — Cover           | ref. 5: 4 machined bars, corner joint, holes, finish                                                     | firm price + lead time                          |
| C — Glazing         | refs 6 and 7: laminated low-iron AR glass and bonding into the rebate (by you or your glazier)           | price, or “excluded” if you prefer we supply it |
| D — Seal and screws | refs 8 and 9                                                                                             | price                                           |
| E — Dry test        | cover screwed on without blocks, $-0.2$ bar through the tubes, 24 h hold (loss $< 50$ mbar)              | price, or included                              |
| Option 1            | visible frame reduced to 50 mm (50×10 flat + 50×24 bar, 24 rebate)                                       | extra / saving, feasibility                     |
| Option 2            | visible finish of the bars: brushed / mirror polished                                                    | extra                                           |
| Option 3            | LED strip at the top of the box: fixings under the top wall + sealed Ø6 stub (ref. 12)                   | extra                                           |
| Delivery            | empty box and dismounted cover, protected, to a stone workshop (Belgium or Switzerland, to be confirmed) | transport price or ex works                     |

## 7. We would value your view on

- 3 mm bent sheet + external angles: enough for back flatness, or would you prefer 4 mm?
- Dressing the frame after welding: machining, or is hand rectification enough for  $\leq 0.3$  mm/m?
- Corner joint of the bars: mitre, corners machined from solid, or a welded frame machined as one piece?
- Solid cord (30 %) or hollow tubular cord (50 %): which lasts better outdoors?
- Standard or tamper-resistant (TR) Torx for the front screws?
- Anything that, in your view, simplifies fabrication without changing the look: discreet frame, no screw in the glass, demountable.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                              |                              |
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8. Schedule and next steps

| Step                                                                    | Timing                                  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Your constructive advice and price estimate                             | within 3 weeks                          |
| Artist's approval, then dimensioned execution drawings (PDF + STEP/DXF) | 2 to 3 weeks                            |
| Firm price and order                                                    | on receipt of the drawings              |
| Fabrication and dry test in the workshop                                | 4 to 6 weeks after order                |
| Delivery to the base (main workshop)                                    | to be agreed together, winter 2026-2027 |

A 200 mm sample of clamping bar with cord and a piece of bonded glass would be a good first step: tell us if you can make it and at what price.

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